

Guilherme Salazar

Goiânia, Goiás, Brazil | github.com/gszr | linkedin.com/in/gszr | gsz@acm.org

Software engineer with 10+ years of experience building foundational API infrastructure. Currently working on AI-agent tooling at Kong (Context Mesh, Model Context Protocol) after years of shaping how traffic flows between services across Kong Gateway and Kong Enterprise.

EXPERIENCE

Sr. Software Engineer — Kong Inc. (Jul 2017–Present)

- **Context Mesh (current)** — Contributing to Kong Context Mesh, bridging AI agents with enterprise APIs via the Model Context Protocol (MCP). Building tooling that turns existing resources into production-ready MCP servers, working across Go (code generation, OpenAPI parsing) and Python (MCP server runtime) to deliver single-file, self-contained servers.
- **Enterprise features** — Built core enterprise capabilities including RBAC, Workspaces, and the first license validation module and license generation API.
- **Plugin ecosystems** — Co-implemented Go plugin support and co-authored several core/enterprise plugins (Request Callout, Proxy Cache, Request Validator, Rate Limiting Advanced, and others).
- **Service mesh** — Collaborated with the Office of the CTO on the initial release of Kuma, now a CNCF Sandbox project.
- **Networking & protocols** — Delivered gRPC proxying support for Kong Gateway.
- **Supply-chain security & compliance** — Co-implemented SBOM generation for Kong Gateway and delivered SLSA-related improvements.
- **Cryptography** — Co-implemented FIPS 140-2 compatibility for Kong Gateway using BoringSSL.
- **Build & delivery automation** — Designed Kong Enterprise's first artifact delivery pipeline, reducing package and Docker image build times to under 10 minutes.
- **Release engineering** — Acted as release engineer for 6 Kong Enterprise releases, plus customer-specific builds.

Backend Engineer — Appbase.io (Oct 2016–Jul 2017)

- Designed and built a data streaming layer for Elasticsearch (2.x and 5.x) based on OpenResty (Nginx + Lua).
- Built tooling to automate Elasticsearch benchmarks end-to-end, from cluster provisioning to benchmark execution using Elasticsearch Rally.

Student Developer — Google Summer of Code 2015 (Mar–Aug 2015)

- Contributed to the NetBSD kernel port of Lua by porting the Lua test suite to kernel space and resolving defects identified in the process. Subsequently accepted as a developer by The NetBSD Foundation.

Programmer — Entregador Online (Jan 2014–Jun 2015)

- Built an Android app for package delivery management and its supporting Spring Boot REST APIs, shipped to the Google Play Store.

EDUCATION

M.Sc, Computer Science — Georgia Institute of Technology (2025, on hold)

- Coursework: Applied Cryptography

B.Sc, Computer Science — Universidade Federal de Goiás (2011–2016)

- Teaching Assistant: Software Construction, Operating Systems, and Formal Languages & Automata
- Research Assistant:
 - 2011–2012: Evaluation of IPv6 stacks for low-power devices
 - 2011: Coordination primitives in event-driven concurrent/distributed systems

Non-Degree, Computer Science — University of South Carolina (2012–2013)

- Full scholarship, awarded by the Ministry of Education, Brazil
- Alpha Lambda Delta Honor Society, Dean's Honor List
- Developed a medical records app for the medical school

TECHNICAL

- **Languages:** Go, C, Lua, Python, Java, Shell
- **Protocols & standards:** MCP, gRPC, OpenAPI, REST
- **Infrastructure:** Docker, Nginx/OpenResty, CI/CD
- **Security & compliance:** FIPS 140-2, BoringSSL, SBOM, SLSA
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, Cassandra, Redis, Memcached, Elasticsearch
- **Systems:** Linux, NetBSD, FreeBSD

ASSOCIATIONS

- Professional Member, Association for Computing Machinery (since 2011)